

UK Port Shipping Intelligence Report

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UK Port Shipping

Weekly Intelligence Report • Week of 28 Jun 2026

PREVIOUS WEEK	CURRENT WEEK	WEEK-ON-WEEK CHANGE	PREDICTED NEXT WEEK
1143	1093	-50 (-4.4%)	1117

Per-Port Shipping Summary

Port	Prev Week	Current Week	Change	Predicted Next	Trend
Dover	281	282	+1	282	↑
Grimsby	107	107	+0	107	→
London	114	100	-14	105	↓
Belfast	92	97	+5	96	↑
Liverpool	96	84	-12	90	↓
Portsmouth	76	76	+0	79	→
Holyhead	57	56	-1	57	↓
Felixstowe	57	50	-7	54	↓
Southampton	70	48	-22	53	↓
Larne	41	41	+0	41	→
Milford Haven	42	41	-1	41	↓
Hull	33	39	+6	36	↑
Teesport	32	34	+2	35	↑
Forth	28	16	-12	20	↓
Tyne	11	15	+4	15	↑
Warrenpoint	6	7	+1	6	↑

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Traffic Highlights

■ Highest Traffic Ports (Current Week)	■ Lowest Traffic Ports (Current Week)
1. Dover — 282 ships	1. Warrenpoint — 7 ships
2. Grimsby — 107 ships	2. Tyne — 15 ships
3. London — 100 ships	3. Forth — 16 ships

Trend Analysis

Of the **16** major UK ports tracked this week, **6** ports saw an increase in shipping activity, **7** ports recorded a decline, and **3** remained stable week-on-week. The strongest gainer was **Hull** (+6 ship visits). The steepest decline was at **Southampton** (-22 ship visits).

Port	WoW Change	% Change	Predicted Direction
Hull	+6	+18.2%	↓ Decreasing
Belfast	+5	+5.4%	↓ Decreasing
Tyne	+4	+36.4%	→ Stable
Teesport	+2	+6.2%	↑ Increasing
Warrenpoint	+1	+16.7%	↓ Decreasing
Dover	+1	+0.4%	→ Stable
Grimsby	+0	+0.0%	→ Stable
Portsmouth	+0	+0.0%	↑ Increasing
Larne	+0	+0.0%	→ Stable
Milford Haven	-1	-2.4%	→ Stable
Holyhead	-1	-1.8%	↑ Increasing
Felixstowe	-7	-12.3%	↑ Increasing
Forth	-12	-42.9%	↑ Increasing
Liverpool	-12	-12.5%	↑ Increasing
London	-14	-12.3%	↑ Increasing
Southampton	-22	-31.4%	↑ Increasing

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Machine Learning Model Performance

The prediction engine uses a **Random Forest Regressor** trained on **6208** weekly observations spanning all major UK ports. Features include current and previous week ship counts, 4-week rolling averages, week number, month, year, and port identity. Model validation uses 5-fold time-series cross-validation to prevent data leakage.

Metric	Train Score	CV Mean $\pm$ Std	Interpretation
MAE (ships)	4.3697	15.8052 $\pm$ 17.9033	Lower is better
RMSE (ships)	7.1381	23.9457 $\pm$ 29.3534	Lower is better
R ² Score	0.9884	0.6986 $\pm$ 0.1854	1.0 = perfect

Methodology & Data Sources

- **Data Source:** Weekly Shipping Indicators Dataset (Department for Transport, UK)
- **Ports Covered:** Grimsby, London, Southampton, Liverpool, Milford Haven, Felixstowe, Teesport, Forth, Dover, Belfast, Holyhead, Larne, Warrenpoint, Portsmouth, Tyne, Hull
- **Time Period:** January 2019 – present (weekly cadence)
- **Model:** Random Forest Regressor (300 trees, max depth 12)
- **Features:** Current count, previous count, 2-week lag, 4-week rolling mean, WoW trend, week/month/year, port encoding
- **Validation:** 5-fold TimeSeriesSplit cross-validation
- **Prediction Target:** Next week's ship visit count for each individual port

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